Lesson 26: Listening and Speaking: A Zero Waste How-To Video

English Stage 1 (B1) · Unit 3: Zero Waste

Adapted from Speaking, Listening and Pronunciation Projects for ELLs - Intermediate Level by Brittany Zemlick, Grossmont College (CC BY 4.0): 3.1 Listening and Speaking - Zero Waste "How To" Video; 3.2 Vocabulary Review.

In this lesson

You will think about trash and how to make less of it. Then you will watch a short "how to" video in which Lauren Singer makes her own zero waste toothpaste. You will learn the words from the video and use them in sentences.

Learning goals

After this lesson you should be able to:

- Talk about trash and give tips to reduce it.
- Understand the main idea and the details of a "how to" video.
- Use the unit words (recycle, upcycle, recipe, alternative, combine, stir and more).
- Name the genre, audience and purpose of a video.
- Give your opinion about making your own products.

Key language

Word or phrase	Meaning in simple English	Example
zero waste	making very little or no trash	Lauren Singer lives a Zero Waste lifestyle.
recycle	send used paper, plastic or glass to be made into new things	Toothpaste tubes are difficult to recycle.
upcycle	find a new way to use something instead of throwing it in the trash	Lauren upcycled a chopstick.
reusable	you can use it again and again (opposite: disposable)	Take a reusable grocery bag when you go shopping.
recipe	a list of instructions and ingredients for making food	Would you try making the recipe in the video?
alternative	another option	We can use wind energy as an alternative to coal.
combine	add together	Combine coconut oil, baking soda and essential oils.

Word or phrase	Meaning in simple English	Example
stir	mix	Lauren uses a chopstick to stir the toothpaste.
consistency	how hard, soft or liquid something is	The consistency might change because of temperature.
fluctuate	change a lot	The consistency of the toothpaste fluctuates.
foam up	turn white and make lots of bubbles	Toothpaste from the store usually foams up.

Rules and explanations

Zero waste

- "Trash" and "waste" mean the same thing: the things we throw away.
- Lauren Singer produces very little or no trash. All of her trash from the past 5 years can fit in one mason jar (a glass jar). One way she reduces her waste is by making her own products, like toothpaste.

Recycle, upcycle, reusable

- **Recycle:** you put plastic, paper or glass in a recycling bin, and it is made into something new.
- **Upcycle:** you find a new use for an old thing yourself.
- **Reusable** things (a bag, cutlery) are used many times. **Disposable** things are used once and thrown away.

Recipe words

- You **combine** the ingredients, **stir** them and measure with a **tablespoon**. Essential oils are natural oils that have different flavors and smells.
- Coconut oil is hard when it's cold and liquid when it's hot, so the consistency **fluctuates**.

Listening to a "how to" video

- Watch first for the **main idea**, then again for **details** (ingredients, tools, steps, tips).
- Then think about its **genre** (the type of video), **audience** (the people it is for) and **purpose** (why it was made).

> **Note for Arabic speakers** - Arabic has no /p/ sound, so /p/ can sound like /b/. This lesson has many /p/ words: peppermint, recipe, toothpaste, upcycle. Say /p/ as in "pen" with a small puff of air; say /b/ as in "baking" with your voice.

Practice

1. Before you watch. The book shows two photos of beaches covered in trash. Think of a beach or street you know with trash, and answer aloud:

- What do you see? Why is there so much trash? Where does it come from?
- What do you think is the solution? How can you reduce the amount of trash you produce?

2. Lauren Singer. How do you think she makes so little trash? Watch the first 27 seconds of the first video (see Watch online). What did you learn about Lauren Singer?

3. Zero waste tips. The book has photos of (A) toothbrushes in a jar, (B) a reusable shopping bag, (C) glass jars full of dry food such as pasta, grains and coffee. Match each photo with a tip:

- a. use a bamboo toothbrush (not plastic)
- b. take a reusable grocery bag when you go shopping
- c. bring your own containers when you go shopping
- d. use reusable cutlery (not disposable)

Then answer: Do you already do some of these things? Which new tip would you like to try? Why?

4. Vocabulary. Write the correct word for each picture or definition. Words: recycle, toothpaste, recipe, alternative, upcycle, combine, coconut oil, baking soda, essential oils, cinnamon, peppermint, chopstick, foam up, liquid, stir, tablespoon

1. old coffee cans, painted and used as pots for plants
2. four coloured bins on the street for sorting recycling
3. coconuts cut in half, with oil in bowls
4. a cartoon man brushing his teeth, with lots of white bubbles around his mouth
5. a box of white powder for cakes and cookies
6. paste on a toothbrush, with a tube behind it
7. measuring spoons of different sizes
8. natural oils that have different flavors and smells
9. a list of instructions and ingredients for making food
10. another option; for example, we can use wind energy instead of coal
11. a jug with brown spice sticks in it
12. add together
13. mix
14. fresh green leaves used for flavor
15. something like water, milk or orange juice
16. long thin wooden sticks for eating

5. Main idea. Watch "Zero Waste Toothpaste" (see Watch online). Note everything you see and understand. Then explain it to your tutor, or record yourself with your phone and listen back.

6. Details. Watch again. Choose the correct answer.

1. What does Lauren teach us to make? lotion / toothpaste / trash / cookies
2. What are the benefits of learning to make this product? a) Toothpaste tubes are difficult to recycle. b) It works really well. c) It's easy and fast to make. d) All of the above.
3. Is it difficult to make? yes / no
4. Does it take a long time to make? yes / no
5. What are the three ingredients? coconut oil / baking soda / essential oils / flour
6. What does Lauren use to stir the toothpaste? a spoon / a chopstick / a fork
7. How is this toothpaste different from toothpaste you buy in the store? a) It doesn't foam up. b) It's not salty. c) It always has a good consistency (not too hard or too soft).
8. The consistency might change because of temperature. What should you do if the toothpaste is too hard? put it under some warm water / put it in the freezer
9. What should you do if the toothpaste is too liquid? put it under some warm water / put it in the freezer

7. After you watch. Choose, and explain your choice aloud.

1. Genre: a children's movie / a "how to" video on YouTube / a presentation / an interview
2. Most likely audience: young children in school / young people who like to travel / people who care about the environment / ESL students
3. Purpose (choose all the correct answers): a) to encourage people to reduce the amount of trash they make b) to teach people to make their own products c) to teach children about farming d) to persuade people to become vegans e) to model an interview
4. Is it a good idea to make your own toothpaste? Why or why not? Would you try the recipe? What other products would you like to learn to make?

8. Vocabulary review. Practise the Unit 3 flashcards on Quizlet (see Watch online). Then complete the sentences. Spell the words correctly.

A. Words: toothpaste, recipe, alternative, recycle, combine, coconut oil, liquids, head to, tablespoon

1. I brush my teeth twice a day, and I use a toothbrush and _____.
2. It's always a good idea to _____ plastic and paper.
3. The recipe says to _____ two eggs, flour and sugar in a bowl.
4. Then you need to add one _____ of cocoa powder.
5. A _____ is a set of instructions for making food.
6. We need to _____ the store. I need to buy some fruit and vegetables.
7. Making your own products like toothpaste and lotion is a good _____ to buying them.
8. _____ is a vegan alternative to butter.
9. Water, milk, and orange juice are examples of _____.

B. Words: baking soda, peppermint, cinnamon, chopstick, upcycle, foams up, consistency, fluctuates, zero waste

1. Toothpaste usually _____ in your mouth when you brush your teeth.
2. When you _____ something, that means you find a new way to use it instead of throwing it in the trash.
3. If you lead a _____ lifestyle, that means you don't make any trash.
4. A _____ is a long wooden stick that people sometimes use instead of a fork to eat food. In the video, Lauren upcycled a _____ and she used it to stir the toothpaste. (Same word for both blanks.)
5. When something _____, that means it changes a lot.
6. _____ and _____ are two examples of flavors you can put in your toothpaste.
7. The _____ of butter and coconut oil can change. When they are hot, they are liquid.
8. I use _____ in cookie and cake recipes, but you can also use it in your toothpaste recipe.

Speak with your tutor

- "I watched a video about making zero waste toothpaste. Ask me five questions about it, one at a time, and correct my answers."
- "Let me explain Lauren's recipe in my own words. Tell me if I forget an ingredient or a tip, and correct my grammar."
- "Let's discuss: Is it a good idea to make your own toothpaste? You disagree with me. Ask me for reasons."
- "Give me the meaning of a word from this lesson, like 'add together'. I say the word and make a sentence with it."

Read aloud

- re·CY·cle
- UP·cy·cle (check)
- REC·i·pe
- al·TER·na·tive
- com·BINE
- con·SIS·ten·cy
- FLUC·tu·ate
- CIN·na·mon
- PEP·per·mint
- TA·ble·spoon

Watch online

- Lauren Singer (watch the first 27 seconds): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZTouqEPzbdo
- Zero Waste Toothpaste, Lauren's "how to" video: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DIpTXQl7qTo

- Unit 3 Zero Waste flashcards on Quizlet: https://quizlet.com/513857903/unit-3-zero-waste-flash-cards/

Answer key

1. (example answer) I see a beach full of plastic trash. It comes from the things people buy and throw away. We can use reusable bags and recycle.

2. (example answer) I think she makes her own products. I learned that she lives a zero waste lifestyle.

3. A - a; B - b; C - c. Tip d goes with the book's second photo. (example answer) I already take a reusable bag. I want to try a bamboo toothbrush, because plastic makes a lot of trash.

4. 1 upcycle, 2 recycle, 3 coconut oil, 4 foam up, 5 baking soda, 6 toothpaste, 7 tablespoon, 8 essential oils, 9 recipe, 10 alternative, 11 cinnamon, 12 combine, 13 stir, 14 peppermint, 15 liquid, 16 chopstick

5. (example answer) Lauren shows how to make toothpaste at home. She combines three ingredients and stirs them with a chopstick. It is easy and fast.

6. (book) 1 toothpaste; 2 d) All of the above; 3 no; 4 no; 5 coconut oil, baking soda, essential oils; 6 a chopstick; 7 a) It doesn't foam up; 8 Put it under some warm water; 9 Put it in the freezer.

7. 1 a "how to" video on YouTube; 2 people who care about the environment; 3 a) and b); 4 (example answer) Yes, because toothpaste tubes are difficult to recycle. I would try it with peppermint. I would also like to learn to make lotion.

8. (book) A: 1 toothpaste, 2 recycle, 3 combine, 4 tablespoon, 5 recipe, 6 head to, 7 alternative, 8 Coconut oil, 9 liquids. B: 1 foams up, 2 upcycle, 3 zero waste, 4 chopstick (both blanks), 5 fluctuates, 6 Cinnamon, peppermint (either order), 7 consistency, 8 baking soda.

My notes